

Speaking

My Family's Story

Pairs · 8-10 min

Interview your partner about a difficult time someone in their family (or an invented family, if they prefer) went through, using past simple and past continuous questions.

Useful language: What was happening when...?, How did your family deal with...?, While this was happening, what were you/they doing?, In the end, they managed to...

1. Think of a hard time (real or invented) that a family member went through.
2. Prepare 4-5 questions to ask your partner about their story, using past simple and past continuous.
3. Take turns interviewing each other and taking short notes.
4. Report your partner's story back to the class in 3-4 sentences.

Then and Now

Groups of 3-4 · 8-10 min

Discuss habits and routines that used to be common in the past (in general, or in your own family/town) but have changed today.

Useful language: People used to..., We didn't use to..., Nowadays, people..., Things have changed because...

1. In groups, brainstorm 5 things people used to do in the past that are different now.
2. Discuss why you think these habits changed.
3. Choose the most interesting example and prepare to share it with the class.
4. Present your example, using 'used to' at least twice.

Writing

A Short Biography: Overcoming a Hard Time

120-150 words

Write a short biographical paragraph about a person (real or invented) who faced a hardship and overcame it. Use past simple, past continuous, and 'used to' at least once each.

Plan:

1. Decide who your subject is and what hardship they faced.
2. List 2-3 key events in the order they happened.
3. Note one thing the person 'used to' do or have that later changed.
4. Think of a sentence describing two things happening at the same time (with 'while').

Checklist:

- ☐ Did I use the past simple correctly for finished events?
- ☐ Did I use the past continuous correctly, including at least one 'while' sentence?
- ☐ Did I use 'used to' correctly for a past habit or state?
- ☐ Did I use at least 3 topic words from the vocabulary list?
- ☐ Is my paragraph within the word limit and organised clearly?

Diary Entry: A Hard Day

100-130 words

Write a diary entry from the point of view of a person living through a difficult period, describing what was happening and what you used to do differently before.

Plan:

1. Choose a specific day and situation to write about.
2. Decide what was happening around the writer at that time.
3. Think of one thing the writer used to do before life became difficult.
4. Add a short reflection at the end about how the writer feels.

Checklist:

- ☐ Is my diary entry written in the first person?
- ☐ Did I include at least one past continuous sentence?
- ☐ Did I include at least one 'used to' sentence?
- ☐ Did I use appropriate topic vocabulary?
- ☐ Does my entry have a clear beginning, middle, and end?